

A Tripod

A must if you plan to shoot for long hours. An unsteady hand can be just as damaging to video quality as improper lighting.

External Microphones

Inbuilt windscreens and audio “zoom” help in improving sound quality. But when audio is important, or if you are just plain finicky about being perfect, opt for external microphones. External audio capture systems such as shot guns (used to record sound over long distances or in noiseless environments such as TV interviews) and omni-directional mics, boom poles (overhead extensions used to position the microphone so that it doesn’t appear in the scene) and microphone stands, wired/wireless lapel microphones, and headphones (for monitoring the sound as it is being recorded) will help you get cleaner audio. Also, get a book on recording audio with video—the subject is a vast area!



Light grips / light “shoe”

These become important when you are shooting in low light and need the extra clarity.



Analogue-to-Digital Conversion

If you have a large number of older analogue tapes and want to transfer them to digital, you will want to look at camcorders that support this feature, as well as playback of analogue tapes.